

A Study on the View of Cyclic Economics in Daesoon Thought

— Money arises and is spent by the principle of circulation —

Circulating the Four Economic Ethics of Confucianism, Buddhism, Taoism and Christianity

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Core Framework — The Fourfold Correspondence

The four economic ethics of Confucianism, Buddhism, Taoism and Christianity circulate; the Daesoon tenets resolve four economic problems.

Religion	Economic Ethic · View	Circulation	Daesoon Tenet	Problem Resolved
Taoism	Libertarianism · Wealth (財富)	Daedae (待對)	Eumyang Hapdeok	Economic motivation
Buddhism	Social Contract · Distribution (分配)	Hoegwi (回歸)	Sinin Johwa	Economic ethics
Confucianism	Utilitarianism · Labor (勞動)	Junghwa (中和)	Haewon Sangsaeng	Economic ideology
Christianity	Communitarianism · Goods (財貨)	Yuhaeng (流行)	Dotong Jingyeong	Environmental crisis

→ Five modes of circulation: Daedae · Yuhaeng · Junghwa · Hoegwi · Spiral (螺線)

Abstract

KEY POINT "Money arises and is spent by the principle of circulation" — Daesoon's cyclic economics circulates the economic thought of Confucianism, Buddhism, Taoism and Christianity to resolve global economic problems.

The Problem — A Paralysis of Circulation

- Modernity forgot that economic thought originated in religion (the three teachings and Western religion)
- Clashes between religions broke their mutual circulation, causing four crises: motivation, ethics, ideology and environment

The Thesis — A Cyclic Economic View

- That the four economic ethics circulate with one another is first asserted by Daesoon Thought
- The tenets — Eumyang Hapdeok, Sinin Johwa, Haewon Sangsaeng, Dotong Jingyeong — harmonize the four ethics

The Method — Postmodern Circulation

- Beyond linear modernity: circulation revives the whole economy as blood revives the body

I. Introduction

Background, Aims and Method

I. Introduction

KEY POINT Framed by the virtuous cycle of religion and economy, the study sets out the need, scope and method of the research.

Structure of the Chapter

- 1. The necessity of the research — four crises from a paralysis of circulation
- 2. Review of prior research — the Eastern origin of Western economics & cyclic thought
- 3. Scope and method — comparing the four economic ethics with the Daesoon tenets

I.1 The Necessity of the Research

Religion and Economy

- Religion → ethics → economy: a virtuous cycle; Weber's 'economic thought is religious thought' revisited
- The rise of Korea, China and Japan re-highlights the cyclic economics of the three teachings

Four Crises of a Paralyzed Circulation

- Individual-economy: collapse of motivation / Individual-ethics: loss of economic ethics
- Community-economy: capitalist–communist conflict / Community-ethics: environmental crisis

The Power of Circulation

- Micro — it supplies the motive for growth; Macro — it heals economic crisis

I.2 Review of Prior Research

① The Eastern Origin of Western Economics

- The 'Chinese origin of Western civilization' (Zhu Qianzhi, Frank, Hobson, Hwang Tae-yeon)
- "Matteo Ricci led the Eastern gods of civilization and opened culture in the West"

② Daesoon's Cyclic Economic Thought

- "Money arises and is spent by the principle of circulation" — a cyclic ethic of distribution

③ Money and Religion

- Research on the circularity of money and its correlation with religious thought

I.3 Scope and Method

Scope

- The four economic ethics of the three teachings and Western religion (wealth, distribution, labor, goods) vs. the Daesoon tenets

Method

- Correlative thinking and circulation theory analyze the triple cycle of religion–ethics–economy
- The circular sequence of the I Ching serves as the theoretical frame

II. Economic Views of Religions & Limited Circularity

Confucianism · Buddhism · Taoism · Christianity

II. Economic Views of Religions & Limited Circularity

KEY POINT Each religion's economic ethic appears as one economic view, yet clashes leave the circulation limited.

Structure of the Chapter

- 1. Economic ethics and the circularity of religions — the four ethical systems
- 2–5. The capitalism and economic ethic of Taoism, Buddhism, Confucianism and Western religion
- Key point: each ethic, losing its circularity, triggers its own economic crisis

II.1 Economic Ethics and the Circularity of Religions

Economy and Ethics

- Like Janus, opposed yet inseparable — a religion's core ethic is voiced as economic thought

The Four Ethical Systems

- Virtue (Aristotle), Right (Kant), Good/Efficiency (libertarian), Utility (utilitarian)

Religion ↔ Economic Ethic

- Taoism–Libertarianism / Buddhism–Social Contract
- Confucianism–Utilitarianism / Western religion–Communitarianism

II.2 Taoist Capitalism & the Libertarian View of Wealth

Taoism and Capitalism

- The thought closest to capitalism — introduced to Europe via Matteo Ricci
- Influenced Adam Smith's 'invisible hand' and the marginalist school

View of Wealth (財富) — Saving

- Calvin's sanction of usury laid the ground for saving

Limit

- Losing its circularity, libertarianism triggers the crisis of economic motivation

II.3 Buddhist Capitalism & the Social-Contractarian View of Distribution

Buddhist Economic Thought

- Rich in economic reference — revived by India's rise and ecology (bodhisattva capitalism)

View of Distribution (分配)

- Affinity between Kant's deontology and Buddhism — social-contractarian distribution

Limit

- Losing its circularity, it triggers the crisis of economic ethics (justice)

II.4 Confucian Capitalism & the Utilitarian View of Labor

Confucian Capitalism

- Engine of East Asian growth — studies by Tu Weiming, Morishima, Hahm Chaibong

View of Labor (勞動)

- Production and diligence — paired with utilitarianism (Keynes–Schumpeter)

Limit

- Bound by Confucian orthodoxy, it loses circulation and triggers ideological conflict

II.5 Western Religion & the Communitarian View of Goods

Western Religion and Capitalism

- Weber's Protestantism — yet charity is the opposite of the Protestant view of wealth

View of Goods (財貨) — Circulation

- Charity = communitarian circulation; it governs 'circulation' among saving–production–circulation–distribution

Limit

- A deficit of circularity triggers the environmental crisis

III. Cyclic Economic View in the Religious Tenets

Eumyang Hapdeok · Sinin Johwa · Haewon Sangsaeng · Dotong Jingyeong

III. Cyclic Economic View in the Religious Tenets

KEY POINT Upon the circular cyclicity of the I Ching, the four tenets set the four economic ethics into mutual life-giving.

Structure of the Chapter

- 1. The I Ching and the circular cyclicity of Daesoon Thought — five modes
- 2–5. Daedae, Hoegwi, Junghwa and Yuhaeng regenerate the four economic ethics
- Eumyang Hapdeok · Sinin Johwa · Haewon Sangsaeng · Dotong Jingyeong

III.1 The I Ching & the Circular Cyclicity of Daesoon Thought

Circle (圓) and Circulation

- The hidden core of Daesoon Thought, and the criterion dividing East from West

The Science of Circulation

- Russell's paradox and incompleteness reveal the scientific validity of the I Ching's cycle

Five Modes of Circulation

- Daedae (待對) · Yuhaeng (流行) · Junghwa (中和) · Hoegwi (回歸) · Spiral (螺線)

III.2 The Daedae Libertarian View of Wealth & Eumyang Hapdeok

The Daedae Cycle

- Yin and yang face one another as complementary pairs in circulation

Eumyang Hapdeok

- Circulating the libertarian view of wealth to recover suppressed economic freedom

III.3 The Return-Based Social Contractarian View of Distribution & Sinin Johwa

The Hoegwi Cycle

- Justice returns to its root — the basic structure of institutions

Sinin Johwa

- Circulating the social-contractarian view of distribution to recover social justice

III.4 The Junghwa Utilitarian View of Labor & Haewon Sangsaeng

The Junghwa Cycle

- Harmonizing opposites toward the common (公)

Haewon Sangsaeng

- Circulating the utilitarian view of labor to recover the true common good

III.5 The Yuhaeng Communitarian View of Goods & Dotong Jingyeong

The Yuhaeng Cycle

- Ceaseless flow reaching everywhere — goods are the fruit of circulation

Dotong Jingyeong

- Circulating the communitarian view of goods to revive the community's primal power

IV. The Value of the Cyclic Economic View

Resolving the Four Economic Problems

IV. The Value of the Cyclic Economic View

KEY POINT The four tenets actually resolve four economic problems — motivation, ethics, ideology and environment.

Fourfold Application

- Eumyang Hapdeok → economic motivation Sinin Johwa → economic ethics
- Haewon Sangsaeng → economic ideology Dotong Jingyeong → the environment

IV.1 Eumyang Hapdeok & the Recovery of Economic Motivation

Problem — Loss of Motivation

- Libertarianism loses circularity, breeding casino-capitalism and collapse of motivation

Daesoon's Answer — Daedae Libertarianism

- Freedom widens from mere market-purchase to reforming the basic structure of institutions
- Eumyang Hapdeok recovers economic motivation

IV.2 Sinin Johwa & the Regeneration of Economic Ethics

Problem — Loss of Ethics

- Losing circularity, social-contract theory lets distributive justice collapse

Daesoon's Answer — Return-Based Social Contract

- Distribution seen as the fruit of circulation regenerates economic ethics
- Sinin Johwa recovers social justice

IV.3 Haewon Sangsaeng & the Harmonization of Economic Ideology

Problem — Ideological Conflict

- Losing circularity, utilitarianism breeds capitalist–communist conflict

Daesoon's Answer — Junghwa Utilitarianism

- A cyclic view of labor harmonizes the ideologies
- Haewon Sangsaeng recovers the common good

IV.4 Dotong Jingyeong & the Overcoming of the Environmental Crisis

Problem — Environmental Crisis

- Communitarianism without care for nature breeds environmental crisis and communal extinction

Daesoon's Answer — Yuhaeng Communitarianism

- A cyclic view of goods overcomes the environmental crisis
- Dotong Jingyeong revives the community's primal power

V. Conclusion

Summary and Significance

V. Conclusion

KEY POINT A new economic view that circulates and gives life to the four economic ethics, resolving four economic problems together.

Summary

- Eumyang Hapdeok, Sinin Johwa, Haewon Sangsaeng and Dotong Jingyeong recover motivation, ethics, ideology and the environment

Significance

- The first claim that the ethical bases — the three teachings and Western religion — mutually circulate
- A postmodern cyclic economics beyond linear modernity

Prospect

- As blood-circulation heals the body, restoring circulation heals today's economic crises